

SUJEET KUMAR MISHRA THE GAMECHANGER OF GIFTING



> **Sujeet Kumar Mishra**

Imagine a little boy in a lower middle class household in small town India to whom the entire concept of a “gift” was alien, to whom “cake” was something not even familiar on birthdays. About three decades later he not only became the founder of one of the fastest growing gifting companies in India, but also became an inspiration for many young people like him in small schools, small town with big dreams who redefine the rules of the game.

Sujeet Kumar Mishra's story and his journey with Winni is not a classical rag to riches tale but a story of a dream, courage, hustle, innovation, perseverance, vision and unflinching determination that led to Winni crossing the 100 Cr Rupees revenue mark in the FY 2021-22 with a GMV of 300 Cr Rupees with 200+ operational bakery stores. Not a mean feat for an entirely bootstrapped company that was close to closure at one point and then literally built up from the gallows to reach to 40+ countries, 23 states & 5 UTs in India and eventually turned profitable in the 9th year of its inception. Winni pivoted its business model in the year 2017 and since then it has grown almost 40X in last 6 years.

Since Winni's inception in 2013, the company has successfully redefined the horizons of e-retailing cakes, flowers, gifts & more. Along with his founding partners Sujeet built India's fastest-growing Online Gifting platform and in almost a decade turned it into the second-largest Online Gifting Platform. With 20 Million annual online customers, 300+ on-ground retail outlets & 450+ manpower, 4000+ vendor

network at pan India level, Winni is recently recognised among “The Most Promising Brands from India-2022” by The Economic Times. It is also recognised among the “Top 50 D2C Brands in India” by Exchange4Media and “The Fastest Growing Franchise of the year -2021” by Franchise India. Under the leadership of Sujeet, Winni has emerged as the only company in this space that has truly nation wide geographical presence leaving behind so many well funded and popular brands in this space.

30 minutes delivery elitism was only available to a large chain delivering pizzas, but Sujeet realized that cakes and gifts need that kind of urgency as well. Winni Cakes & more promises a 2 hours delivery to about 2000 pin codes pan-India and delivers cakes faster or at pace with pizzas in 22 cities now. Winni's leaps can be understood in microsegments as well, for instance in 2017 Winni started delivering to 3 countries and by 2021 they were delivering in 40 countries including the USA, the Middle East and Europe.

Using his survival instinct learnt in his tough days at Ramjas College, Delhi University and the skills he picked in his Management career afterwards Sujeet understands customer behavior in tier 2 and tier 3 cities as adeptly as he understands the market dynamics in India's gifting and bakery industry. Winni has already sold 300+ franchises in the current financial year under the brand name Winni Cakes & More, and it has plans to expand fast in next financial year. The company has an ambitious plan to open stores

in different geographies globally by 2025 to expand its business and serve its customers in APAC countries, USA, Europe, Middle East, Australia & many more.

The success story of Winni based in Panchkula, a small township north of Chandigarh that is not even known by most big cities still is a story of the owning of aspirational dreams of emerging India. Sujeet along with his co-founders Chander Pal, Abhishek Sharma & Sonali Gour has been able to suitably blend his lived experiences in these small towns with his global vision about how companies and businesses must be run ethically and efficiently at the same time.

India being a celebrate-every-day kind of a society, Sujeet understood that cakes would become more relevant and more accessible if they are extended to other occasions than just birthdays and anniversaries and the highly unorganised bakery industry could be organised well by solving the inherent industry challenges through innovation & technology. Winni thus ended up being a popular and trustworthy singular online destination for gifts and cakes for a diverse variety of occasions and emerged as the second largest online gifting company & the fastest growing bakery retail chain that serves to 700+ cities in India.

Someone famously said if you know the way of the cake, you know the way of happiness! Sujeet's and Winni's story of perseverance and taking all the rights risks fearlessly certainly proves they have definitely got the cakes & more story just right, which makes him a gamechanger in true sense!